

Create a Git Repository

Git Repository Basics

Learning objective

Create a new local Git repository and confirm that Git is tracking the project.

Core idea

A repository is a project folder whose changes are tracked by Git. Running **git init** creates a hidden **.git** directory that stores the project's history and configuration.

Commands to know

Command / pattern	Purpose
<code>mkdir my-project</code>	Create a project folder
<code>cd my-project</code>	Enter the folder
<code>git init</code>	Initialize the repository
<code>git status</code>	Check the repository state

Step-by-step workflow

- 1. Open a terminal in the location where you keep projects.
- 2. Create and enter a new project folder.
- 3. Run **git init** once.
- 4. Run **git status** to confirm the repository is ready.

Common mistakes

- Running **git init** in the wrong folder.
- Deleting the hidden **.git** directory, which removes local Git history.
- Initializing a repository repeatedly when it already exists.

Practice task

Create a folder named **githero-practice**, initialize it, and run **git status**. You should see that you are on a branch and have no commits yet.

Quick check

What hidden directory makes a normal folder into a Git repository?

Tip: Run **git status** before and after important Git commands so you can observe what changed.